

Yaren Koca, PhD

yarenkoca.com

yarennkoca@gmail.com | Dept. of Psychology, University of Regina

Education

2021–26 PhD, Experimental and Applied Psychology, University of Regina

Supervisor: Chris Oriet

Thesis Title: Representation of Familiarity in the Face Space

GPA: 95.00%

2019-21 M.A., Experimental and Applied Psychology, University of Regina

Supervisor: Chris Oriet

Thesis Title: Statistical Summary Representations in Identity Learning: Exemplar-Independent Incidental Recognition

GPA: 90.75%

2015-19 B.A., Psychology, Bilkent University

Supervisor: Huseyin Boyaci

Thesis Title: The Role of Surround Suppression and Spatial Summation in Human Motion Perception

GPA: 3.69/4.0

Awards, Grants, and Honours

2025 Doctoral Scholarship Award (\$14,000 CAD), University of Regina

2025 FGSR Thesis Only Scholarship (\$6,000 CAD), University of Regina

2025 FGSR INSPIRE Symposium Best Presenter (\$500), University of Regina

2024 Doctoral Scholarship Award (\$21,000 CAD), University of Regina

2024 FGSR Thesis Only Scholarship (\$6,250 CAD), University of Regina

2024 International Doctoral Student Award (\$1400 CAD per semester), University of Regina

2023 Doctoral Scholarship Award (\$21,000 CAD), University of Regina

2022 Master's Thesis Academic Excellence Award, Canadian Psychological Association

2021 FGSR Women in STEM Entrance Scholarship (\$10,000 CAD)

2021 Teaching Assistant Award, Council of Canadian Departments of Psychology

2021 Master's Award (\$130 CAD)

2019-21 Master's Scholarship (\$17,500 CAD per year)

2020 UR Graduate Scholarship (\$1800 CAD)

2019 Faculty of Arts Entrance Award (\$10,000 CAD)

2016-19 Government of Türkiye KYK Scholarship (11,925₺)

2015-19 Comprehensive Scholarship, Bilkent University

2015-19 High Honour Degree, Bilkent University

Teaching

2022–26 PSYC270 – Human Information Processing, University of Regina

2023–25 PSCYC375 – Perception, University of Regina

Academic Advising

2023-24 Logan Ueckert (Honours Thesis), University of Regina

2022-23 Magdalyn Derow (Honours Thesis), University of Regina

Teaching Assistant Positions

- 2021 PSYC255 – Biological Foundations of Behaviour, University of Regina
2021 PSYC455 – Psychoactive Drug Effects on Brain and Behaviour, University of Regina
2020 PSYC375 – Perception, University of Regina
2020 PSYC270 – Human Information Processing, University of Regina
2020 PSYC204 – Research Methods, University of Regina
2016-18 CS123 – Introduction to Computer Science and Programming, Bilkent University

Publications ([Web of Science](#))

- Koca, Y.,** Corpuz, R. L., Oriet, C. (2024). Crowding the face space: The attractor field hypothesis and within-person variability. *Visual Cognition* 32(3), 215–233. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13506285.2024.2409271>
Kramer, R.S., Koca, Y., Mireku, M. O., Oriet, C. (2024). Anchoring has little effect when forming first impressions of facial attractiveness. *Perception* 53(11-12), 787-802. <https://doi.org/10.1177/03010066241284956>
Koca, Y., Oriet, C. (2023). From pictures to the people in them: Averaging within-person variability leads to face familiarization. *Psychological Science* 34(2) 252–264. <https://doi.org/10.1177/095679762211315>

Manuscripts in Preparation (^advisee)

- Ueckert^, L., **Koca, Y.,** Oriet, C. (*submitted*). Is that BOB or is that the butcher? The role of context in the butcher-on-the-bus phenomenon. *Memory & Cognition*
Binnendyk, J., **Koca, Y.,** Pennycook, G. (*in preparation*). Does confidence transfer across cognitive tasks?
Koca, Y., Oriet, C. (*in preparation*). How do we organize facial identity in memory?
Koca, Y., Oriet, C. (*in preparation*). Adaptive norm-based coding of within-person facial variability

Conference Talks (^advisee)

- Ueckert^, L., **Koca, Y.,** Oriet, C. (2025). The importance of context in face recognition. *CSBBCS 2025 Meeting, University of Dundee*
Koca, Y., Corpuz, R., Oriet, C. (2024). Crowding the face space: The attractor field hypothesis and within-person variability. *INSPIRE 2024 Research Symposium, University of Regina*
Koca, Y., Derow^, M., Oriet, C. (2023). Are expectations of obstructed facial features accurate? *CSBBCS 2023 Meeting, University of Guelph*

Poster Presentations (^advisee)

- Koca, Y.,** Corpuz, R., Oriet, C. (2024). Crowding the face space: The attractor field hypothesis and within-person variability. *CSBBCS 2024 Meeting, University of Alberta*
Ueckert^, L., **Koca, Y.,** Oriet, C. (2024). I know that person! Why can't I remember? *CSBBCS 2024 Meeting, University of Alberta*
Koca, Y., Oriet, C. (2021). Statistical Summary Representations in Identity Learning: Exemplar Independent Incidental Recognition. *CSBBCS 2021 Meeting, McGill University*
Koca, Y., Corpuz, R., Oriet, C. (2021). I guess I just have one of those faces: The effect of similar intervening identities on familiarization. *Vision Sciences Society 2021 Meeting*
Koca, Y. (2019). The role of surround suppression and spatial summation on human motion perception. *Bilkent University Senior Project Poster Presentation*

Invited Talks

2021 SSRs in Identity Learning: Exemplar-Independent Incidental Recognition, AFC Lab Talk Series

Workshops

2025 Using Python for Programming Psychology Experiments, INSPIRE Quantitative Workshop Series

2023 Getting Started with Obsidian, McGill University HD Seminar

2023 Programming with PsychoPy3, University of Regina EAP Stats Workshop

Research Experience

2018– R.I.C.E. Lab (Supervisor: Chris Oriet), University of Regina

2018-19 Computational and Biological Vision Group (Supervisor: Huseyin Boyaci), Bilkent University

2015-18 Visual Perception & Attention Lab (Supervisors: Jennifer Corbett & Jaap Munneke), Bilkent University

2017-18 Computational Vision Lab (Supervisor: Aaron Clarke), Bilkent University

2017 Timing & Decision Making Lab (Supervisor: Fuat Balci), Koç University

2017 Evolutionary Psychology Lab (Supervisor: Laith Al-Shawaf), Bilkent University

Academic Service and Volunteer Positions

2025 Faculty of Graduate Studies and Research Student Excellence Awards Committee Member

2023– University of Regina Student Associate Departmental Representative, CSBBCS

2021– Psychology Participant Pool Coordinator, University of Regina

2022 CERC Review Committee Student Volunteer, University of Regina

2020-23 Webmaster, University of Regina Psychology Graduate Student Association

2016-17 Executive Board Member and Chair, Bilkent University Psychology Community

2016-17 Bilkent University Student Representative, Psychology Students Act Platform (PÖMYAP)

Professional Memberships

2024–25 American Psychological Association

2024–25 Psychonomics Society

2021– Canadian Society for Brain, Behaviour, and Cognitive Science (CSBBCS)

2021-22 Vision Sciences Society (VSS)

Certificates

2021 V-VSS 2021 Certificate of Participation, Vision Sciences Society

2020 Student Teaching Certificate, University of Regina

2020 Tri-Council Certificate, Panel on Research Ethics

2017 Summer Research Program Participation Certificate, Koç University

Media Coverage

Davidenko, N. (2024) [How much do first impressions really matter?](#) Psychology Today

Peer Reviews ([Web of Science](#))

Psychonomic Bulletin & Review; Visual Cognition

Skills and Languages

R, Python (PsychoPy3), JavaScript (jsPsych), Git (Basic), TeX (Basic), MATLAB (PsychToolbox), JASP, SPSS, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Turkish, English

References

Dr. Chris Oriet

chris.orient@uregina.ca

Academic Supervisor

Dr. Kaila Bruer

kaila.bruer@uregina.ca

Thesis Committee Member

Dr. Sarah Sangster

sarah.sangster@uregina.ca

Undergraduate Coordinator